

30 • RC SUPPLEMENT — 10 FRESH PASSAGES × 5

ARCHETYPES (50 Qs)

Ten fresh exam-style passages (200–300 words each), each carrying the exact 5-question architecture of the real paper. Read the passage, answer, then check Answer → Trick → Solution → Trap. Every passage is repeated under all of its questions, so each question works standalone.

PASSAGE 1

Q1. What is the central theme of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Wetlands — marshes, swamps and shallow lakes — were once dismissed as wastelands fit only for draining and filling. Through the twentieth century, cities and farms reclaimed them at a remarkable pace, turning floodplains into housing colonies and paddy fields. Only later did engineers discover what had been lost. Their value shows up on no balance sheet, which is exactly why it was ignored for so long. A healthy wetland acts as a sponge: it absorbs monsoon runoff, releases water slowly through dry spells and filters pollutants before they reach rivers and wells. When the wetlands around a city vanish, the first sign of trouble is often not ecological but financial — flooded basements, choked drains and rising water bills. Restoration, however, is neither quick nor cheap. Replanting reeds, reshaping channels and reconnecting old streams can take years. Yet the benefits surface slowly, which makes such projects hard to defend in budget meetings where a new drain promises instant results. In one eastern Indian town, volunteers spent five years reviving a fifty-acre marsh; the reward was a lake that now recharges nearly a hundred wells and shelters flocks of migratory birds. The lesson is not that every marsh must be saved, but that the decision to drain one is far more expensive than it looks. Wetlands, in short, are not idle land. They are quiet infrastructure — cheap to keep, costly to replace.

- A. Wetlands are attractive mainly because they shelter migratory birds.
- B. Cities should stop expanding altogether to protect floodplains.
- C. Wetlands are quiet infrastructure — costly to lose and slow but valuable to restore.
- D. Draining marshes is a sensible way to fund urban growth.

Answer: C — Wetlands are quiet infrastructure whose loss costs more than it looks.

Trick: Choose the option that covers both the loss and the restoration, in the closing image of the passage.

Solution: The passage calls wetlands ‘quiet infrastructure — cheap to keep, costly to replace’ and warns that draining is ‘far more expensive than it looks’, so C alone spans the whole argument.

Trap: B sounds protective, but the passage never asks cities to stop growing — it argues about the cost of draining wetlands.

Q2. Which of the following facts is explicitly stated in the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Wetlands — marshes, swamps and shallow lakes — were once dismissed as wastelands fit only for draining and filling. Through the twentieth century, cities and farms reclaimed them at a remarkable pace, turning floodplains into housing colonies and paddy fields. Only later did engineers discover what had been lost. Their value shows up on no balance sheet, which is exactly why it was ignored for so long. A healthy wetland acts as a sponge: it absorbs monsoon runoff, releases water slowly through dry spells and filters pollutants before they reach rivers and wells. When the wetlands around a city vanish, the first sign of trouble is often not ecological but financial — flooded basements, choked drains and rising water bills. Restoration, however, is neither quick nor cheap. Replanting reeds, reshaping channels and reconnecting old streams can take years. Yet the benefits surface slowly, which makes such projects hard to defend in budget meetings where a new drain promises instant results. In one eastern Indian town, volunteers spent five years reviving a fifty-acre marsh; the reward was a lake that now recharges nearly a hundred wells and shelters flocks of migratory birds. The lesson is not that every marsh must be saved, but that the decision to drain one is far more expensive than it looks. Wetlands, in short, are not idle land. They are quiet infrastructure — cheap to keep, costly to replace.

- A. The first sign of trouble when wetlands vanish is often financial.
- B. Restoration projects pay for themselves within five years.
- C. The fifty-acre marsh was revived by government engineers.
- D. Wetlands filter pollutants only during the monsoon season.

Answer: A — Flooded basements and rising water bills are the early warning.

Trick: Match each option against a single sentence; only one survives verbatim.

Solution: The passage states that when wetlands vanish, 'the first sign of trouble is often not ecological but financial' — flooded basements, choked drains and rising water bills.

Trap: C borrows a real event (a marsh was revived) but swaps volunteers for engineers; D narrows filtration to one season, which the passage never says.

Q3. Which of the following best reflects the connection to real-life situations?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Wetlands — marshes, swamps and shallow lakes — were once dismissed as wastelands fit only for draining and filling. Through the twentieth century, cities and farms reclaimed them at a remarkable pace, turning floodplains into housing colonies and paddy fields. Only later did engineers discover what had been lost. Their value shows up on no balance sheet, which is exactly why it was ignored for so long. A healthy wetland acts as a sponge: it absorbs monsoon runoff, releases water slowly through dry spells and filters pollutants before they reach rivers and wells. When the wetlands around a city vanish, the first sign of trouble is often not ecological but financial — flooded basements, choked drains and rising water bills. Restoration, however, is neither quick nor cheap. Replanting reeds, reshaping channels and reconnecting old streams can take years. Yet the benefits surface slowly, which makes such projects hard to defend in budget meetings where a new drain promises instant results. In one eastern Indian town, volunteers spent five years reviving a fifty-acre marsh; the reward was a lake that now recharges nearly a hundred wells and shelters flocks of migratory birds. The lesson is not that every marsh must be saved, but that the decision to drain one is far more expensive than it looks. Wetlands, in short, are not idle land. They are quiet infrastructure — cheap to keep, costly to replace.

A. A city plants decorative fountains in its central square.

B. A factory treats its waste before releasing it into a river.

C. A village bans all construction on farmland.

D. A town restores a marsh so it can absorb floodwater instead of building a costly drain.

Answer: D — Letting the wetland do the sponge-work is the lesson in action.

Trick: Find the option where a wetland itself does the job the passage describes — absorbing runoff.

Solution: The passage says a healthy wetland 'absorbs monsoon runoff' and releases it slowly; D applies exactly that sponge role in a real decision.

Trap: B looks green, but the passage is about wetlands as infrastructure, not factory treatment plants.

Q4. What is the organisational structure of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Wetlands — marshes, swamps and shallow lakes — were once dismissed as wastelands fit only for draining and filling. Through the twentieth century, cities and farms reclaimed them at a remarkable pace, turning floodplains into housing colonies and paddy fields. Only later did engineers discover what had been lost. Their value shows up on no balance sheet, which is exactly why it was ignored for so long. A healthy wetland acts as a sponge: it absorbs monsoon runoff, releases water slowly through dry spells and filters pollutants before they reach rivers and wells. When the wetlands around a city vanish, the first sign of trouble is often not ecological but financial — flooded basements, choked drains and rising water bills. Restoration, however, is neither quick nor cheap. Replanting reeds, reshaping channels and reconnecting old streams can take years. Yet the benefits surface slowly, which makes such projects hard to defend in budget meetings where a new drain promises instant results. In one eastern Indian town, volunteers spent five years reviving a fifty-acre marsh; the reward was a lake that now recharges nearly a hundred wells and shelters flocks of migratory birds. The lesson is not that every marsh must be saved, but that the decision to drain one is far more expensive than it looks. Wetlands, in short, are not idle land. They are quiet infrastructure — cheap to keep, costly to replace.

A. A problem is stated, several solutions are compared, and the cheapest is recommended.

B. The draining of wetlands is described, their value is explained, and a cost conclusion is drawn.

C. Two opposing views on wetlands are debated and the author stays neutral.

D. A historical anecdote is narrated and a moral about birds is added.

Answer: B — Loss, value, then the cost lesson.

Trick: Track the movement: past mistake → sponge value → cost lesson.

Solution: The passage moves from wetlands being 'dismissed as wastelands', through their 'sponge' value, to the conclusion that draining one is 'far more expensive than it looks'.

Trap: A copies the problem–solution–conclusion shape but invents a comparison of solutions and a cheapest pick — the passage compares no options.

Q5. Identify the tone of the passage.

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Wetlands — marshes, swamps and shallow lakes — were once dismissed as wastelands fit only for draining and filling. Through the twentieth century, cities and farms reclaimed them at a remarkable pace, turning floodplains into housing colonies and paddy fields. Only later did engineers discover what had been lost. Their value shows up on no balance sheet, which is exactly why it was ignored for so long. A healthy wetland acts as a sponge: it absorbs monsoon runoff, releases water slowly through dry spells and filters pollutants before they reach rivers and wells. When the wetlands around a city vanish, the first sign of trouble is often not ecological but financial — flooded basements, choked drains and rising water bills. Restoration, however, is neither quick nor cheap. Replanting reeds, reshaping channels and reconnecting old streams can take years. Yet the benefits surface slowly, which makes such projects hard to defend in budget meetings where a new drain promises instant results. In one eastern Indian town, volunteers spent five years reviving a fifty-acre marsh; the reward was a lake that now recharges nearly a hundred wells and shelters flocks of migratory birds. The lesson is not that every marsh must be saved, but that the decision to drain one is far more expensive than it looks. Wetlands, in short, are not idle land. They are quiet infrastructure — cheap to keep, costly to replace.

- A. Concerned but practical and quietly persuasive.
- B. Bitter and accusatory towards city planners.
- C. Light-hearted and humorous.
- D. Purely neutral, offering no opinion.

Answer: A — The author warns, reasons, then recommends — without anger or jokes.

Trick: Tone follows the verbs: warns, explains, concludes — no anger, no jokes.

Solution: The passage warns ('the first sign of trouble'), reasons ('Restoration, however, is neither quick nor cheap') and closes with a measured recommendation ('cheap to keep, costly to replace').

Trap: D fails because the closing line is a clear opinion; B overshoots the calm, evidence-led criticism.

PASSAGE 2

Q6. What is the central theme of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The ocean has always carried what people throw into it, but the modern tide of plastic is different in kind. Bottles, bags and fishing nets do not dissolve; they break into smaller and smaller fragments that scientists call microplastics. These particles now drift in every sea, from the surface to the deepest trenches, and enter the food chain through the smallest creatures. Plankton mistake the fragments for food; fish eat the plankton; seabirds and turtles eat the fish. By the time the debris reaches a dinner plate, its origin is invisible. What was dropped on a beach in one country can end up in the stomach of a bird on the other side of the world. However, cleaning the ocean is far harder than filling it. Skimming fleets can collect large floating debris, but microplastics are too small and too scattered for any net, and the plastic that sinks stays sunk. The only durable answer lies upstream — in producing less plastic, designing bottles and wrappers that can be refilled or reused, and stopping waste before it reaches a drain. Some coastal towns have shown what is possible: after banning single-use plastics and organising weekly beach clean-ups, they report fewer entangled turtles and cleaner fishing grounds. The sea, as one marine biologist put it, does not throw anything back. What enters it stays in circulation — unless it is never allowed to enter.

- A. Ocean clean-up fleets can remove all plastic if they are funded generously.
- B. Plastic pollution is spreading through marine life, and the lasting fix is to stop waste at its source.
- C. Turtles are the species most harmed by ocean debris.
- D. Microplastics are harmless because they are too small to matter.

Answer: B — Pollution travels the food chain; prevention beats clean-up.

Trick: Reject options that overstate clean-up or single out one species.

Solution: The passage traces plastic from plankton to fish to 'a dinner plate' and concludes the 'only durable answer lies upstream', so B captures both halves.

Trap: A sounds hopeful, but the passage says microplastics are 'too small and too scattered for any net'.

Q7. Which of the following facts is explicitly stated in the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The ocean has always carried what people throw into it, but the modern tide of plastic is different in kind. Bottles, bags and fishing nets do not dissolve; they break into smaller and smaller fragments that scientists call microplastics. These particles now drift in every sea, from the surface to the deepest trenches, and

enter the food chain through the smallest creatures. Plankton mistake the fragments for food; fish eat the plankton; seabirds and turtles eat the fish. By the time the debris reaches a dinner plate, its origin is invisible. What was dropped on a beach in one country can end up in the stomach of a bird on the other side of the world. However, cleaning the ocean is far harder than filling it. Skimming fleets can collect large floating debris, but microplastics are too small and too scattered for any net, and the plastic that sinks stays sunk. The only durable answer lies upstream — in producing less plastic, designing bottles and wrappers that can be refilled or reused, and stopping waste before it reaches a drain. Some coastal towns have shown what is possible: after banning single-use plastics and organising weekly beach clean-ups, they report fewer entangled turtles and cleaner fishing grounds. The sea, as one marine biologist put it, does not throw anything back. What enters it stays in circulation — unless it is never allowed to enter.

- A. Microplastics are found only near the surface of the sea.
- B. Fishing nets dissolve slowly in seawater.
- C. Beach clean-ups are held daily in every coastal town.
- D. Plankton mistake plastic fragments for food.

Answer: D — The entry point of plastic into the food chain.

Trick: Check each claim against one sentence; three add words the passage never wrote.

Solution: The passage states plainly: 'Plankton mistake the fragments for food; fish eat the plankton; seabirds and turtles eat the fish.'

Trap: A reverses the line 'from the surface to the deepest trenches'; C upgrades 'weekly' clean-ups to daily ones in every town.

Q8. Which of the following best reflects the connection to real-life situations?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The ocean has always carried what people throw into it, but the modern tide of plastic is different in kind. Bottles, bags and fishing nets do not dissolve; they break into smaller and smaller fragments that scientists call microplastics. These particles now drift in every sea, from the surface to the deepest trenches, and enter the food chain through the smallest creatures. Plankton mistake the fragments for food; fish eat the plankton; seabirds and turtles eat the fish. By the time the debris reaches a dinner plate, its origin is invisible. What was dropped on a beach in one country can end up in the stomach of a bird on the other side of the world. However, cleaning the ocean is far harder than filling it. Skimming fleets can collect large floating debris, but microplastics are too small and too scattered for any net, and the plastic that sinks stays sunk. The only durable answer lies upstream — in producing less plastic, designing bottles and wrappers that can be refilled or reused, and stopping waste before it reaches a drain. Some coastal towns have shown what is possible: after banning single-use plastics and organising weekly beach clean-ups, they report fewer entangled turtles and cleaner fishing grounds. The sea, as one marine biologist put it, does not throw anything back. What enters it stays in circulation — unless it is never allowed to enter.

- A. A café replaces disposable cups with steel tumblers customers return.
- B. A city buys a machine to scoop floating bottles from its river.
- C. A family sorts plastic for the municipal truck.
- D. A school screens a film about injured turtles.

Answer: A — Cutting plastic at the point of use is the upstream fix.

Trick: Ask which option stops plastic before it becomes waste.

Solution: The passage says the durable answer lies 'in producing less plastic' and in 'designing bottles and wrappers that can be refilled or reused'; A does exactly that.

Trap: B feels active, but scooping floating debris is the skimming the passage calls insufficient; D only raises awareness without reducing waste.

Q9. What is the organisational structure of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The ocean has always carried what people throw into it, but the modern tide of plastic is different in kind. Bottles, bags and fishing nets do not dissolve; they break into smaller and smaller fragments that scientists call microplastics. These particles now drift in every sea, from the surface to the deepest trenches, and enter the food chain through the smallest creatures. Plankton mistake the fragments for food; fish eat the plankton; seabirds and turtles eat the fish. By the time the debris reaches a dinner plate, its origin is invisible. What was dropped on a beach in one country can end up in the stomach of a bird on the other side of the world. However, cleaning the ocean is far harder than filling it. Skimming fleets can collect large floating debris, but microplastics are too small and too scattered for any net, and the plastic that sinks stays sunk. The only durable answer lies upstream — in producing less plastic, designing bottles and wrappers that can be refilled or reused, and stopping waste before it reaches a drain. Some coastal towns have shown

what is possible: after banning single-use plastics and organising weekly beach clean-ups, they report fewer entangled turtles and cleaner fishing grounds. The sea, as one marine biologist put it, does not throw anything back. What enters it stays in circulation — unless it is never allowed to enter.

- A. A problem is described and several technologies are ranked by cost.
- B. A personal story opens the passage and a scientific explanation follows.
- C. The problem is described, its path through the food chain traced, and a solution with evidence is proposed.
- D. Two scientists debate and the passage ends without a conclusion.

Answer: C — Problem, path through the food chain, then an upstream solution.

Trick: Follow the movement from fragments to food chain to fix.

Solution: The passage describes plastic fragments, traces them into ‘the food chain’, and proposes the upstream answer, citing coastal towns with ‘fewer entangled turtles’.

Trap: A invents a cost ranking; the passage evaluates no technologies by price.

Q10. The word ‘durable’ as used in the text suggests ____.

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The ocean has always carried what people throw into it, but the modern tide of plastic is different in kind. Bottles, bags and fishing nets do not dissolve; they break into smaller and smaller fragments that scientists call microplastics. These particles now drift in every sea, from the surface to the deepest trenches, and enter the food chain through the smallest creatures. Plankton mistake the fragments for food; fish eat the plankton; seabirds and turtles eat the fish. By the time the debris reaches a dinner plate, its origin is invisible. What was dropped on a beach in one country can end up in the stomach of a bird on the other side of the world. However, cleaning the ocean is far harder than filling it. Skimming fleets can collect large floating debris, but microplastics are too small and too scattered for any net, and the plastic that sinks stays sunk. The only durable answer lies upstream — in producing less plastic, designing bottles and wrappers that can be refilled or reused, and stopping waste before it reaches a drain. Some coastal towns have shown what is possible: after banning single-use plastics and organising weekly beach clean-ups, they report fewer entangled turtles and cleaner fishing grounds. The sea, as one marine biologist put it, does not throw anything back. What enters it stays in circulation — unless it is never allowed to enter.

- A. expensive
- B. brief
- C. lasting
- D. difficult

Answer: C — A fix that endures, not one that is merely hard.

Trick: Replace the word in the sentence: the only ____ answer = the only answer that lasts.

Solution: ‘The only durable answer lies upstream’ — here durable means a lasting solution, one that keeps working, so C fits.

Trap: D tempts because the passage says cleaning is ‘far harder’; B is the opposite sense of the word; A drifts in from budget thinking.

PASSAGE 3

Q11. What is the central theme of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Until a decade ago, a worker sending money home from a city had few options: a postal order, a long queue at a bank branch, or a friend travelling to the same village. The money sometimes arrived late; it rarely arrived whole. For families that lived on weekly wages, that uncertainty was a quiet tax on every month. Digital payment systems have changed that arithmetic. A shopkeeper in a small town can now accept a payment in seconds, and a daily-wage labourer can send wages home before boarding the evening bus. The change is not merely one of speed. Small merchants who once kept cash under the counter now have a record of their sales, and that record can unlock a loan that a bank would never have granted to someone with no papers. Yet the shift has not been even. Poor connectivity, low literacy and the fear of fraud keep many users away, and a failed transaction at the wrong moment can cost a family a day’s earnings. The sensible path is neither to force every payment online nor to dismiss digital money as a fad. It is to keep cash available while making digital rails reliable, cheap and trustworthy, so that a village does not have to choose between the old queue and the new screen. Convenience, after all, is only worth having when it is shared.

- A. Digital payments have eased money transfers in small towns, but the shift must become reliable and inclusive.
- B. Postal orders were the safest way to send money home.
- C. Cash should be abolished because it is inefficient.

D. Banks refuse loans to every small merchant.

Answer: A — Speed has arrived; reliability and inclusion lag behind.

Trick: Pick the option that holds the benefit and the caution together.

Solution: The passage shows shopkeepers accepting payments 'in seconds' yet notes that connectivity, literacy and fraud fears 'keep many users away', closing with the need to make digital rails 'reliable, cheap and trustworthy'.

Trap: C inverts the passage, which asks to 'keep cash available'; D exaggerates — records 'can unlock a loan', not that banks refuse all.

Q12. Which of the following facts is explicitly stated in the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Until a decade ago, a worker sending money home from a city had few options: a postal order, a long queue at a bank branch, or a friend travelling to the same village. The money sometimes arrived late; it rarely arrived whole. For families that lived on weekly wages, that uncertainty was a quiet tax on every month. Digital payment systems have changed that arithmetic. A shopkeeper in a small town can now accept a payment in seconds, and a daily-wage labourer can send wages home before boarding the evening bus. The change is not merely one of speed. Small merchants who once kept cash under the counter now have a record of their sales, and that record can unlock a loan that a bank would never have granted to someone with no papers. Yet the shift has not been even. Poor connectivity, low literacy and the fear of fraud keep many users away, and a failed transaction at the wrong moment can cost a family a day's earnings. The sensible path is neither to force every payment online nor to dismiss digital money as a fad. It is to keep cash available while making digital rails reliable, cheap and trustworthy, so that a village does not have to choose between the old queue and the new screen. Convenience, after all, is only worth having when it is shared.

A. Digital payments have fully replaced cash in villages.

B. Every small merchant can now get a bank loan.

C. A shopkeeper in a small town can accept a payment in seconds.

D. Fraud has disappeared from digital transactions.

Answer: C — One verbatim, testable claim.

Trick: Eliminate options containing words like fully, every and disappeared — the passage is careful with such words.

Solution: The passage says directly: 'A shopkeeper in a small town can now accept a payment in seconds'.

Trap: B overstates 'can unlock a loan' into a guarantee; A contradicts the advice to 'keep cash available'.

Q13. Which of the following best reflects the connection to real-life situations?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Until a decade ago, a worker sending money home from a city had few options: a postal order, a long queue at a bank branch, or a friend travelling to the same village. The money sometimes arrived late; it rarely arrived whole. For families that lived on weekly wages, that uncertainty was a quiet tax on every month. Digital payment systems have changed that arithmetic. A shopkeeper in a small town can now accept a payment in seconds, and a daily-wage labourer can send wages home before boarding the evening bus. The change is not merely one of speed. Small merchants who once kept cash under the counter now have a record of their sales, and that record can unlock a loan that a bank would never have granted to someone with no papers. Yet the shift has not been even. Poor connectivity, low literacy and the fear of fraud keep many users away, and a failed transaction at the wrong moment can cost a family a day's earnings. The sensible path is neither to force every payment online nor to dismiss digital money as a fad. It is to keep cash available while making digital rails reliable, cheap and trustworthy, so that a village does not have to choose between the old queue and the new screen. Convenience, after all, is only worth having when it is shared.

A. A bank closes its village branch because everyone now uses phones.

B. A village keeps its bank branch open while also training residents to use secure payment apps.

C. A shop refuses digital payments to avoid keeping records.

D. A government makes digital payment compulsory for all purchases.

Answer: B — Keep the old rail running while the new one earns trust.

Trick: Choose the option that balances cash and digital rails, as the passage demands.

Solution: The passage urges the path 'neither to force every payment online nor to dismiss digital money as a fad', and to 'keep cash available while making digital rails reliable' — B is that balance.

Trap: D is the forcing the passage rejects; A is the abandonment it warns against.

Q14. What is the organisational structure of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Until a decade ago, a worker sending money home from a city had few options: a postal order, a long queue at a bank branch, or a friend travelling to the same village. The money sometimes arrived late; it rarely arrived

whole. For families that lived on weekly wages, that uncertainty was a quiet tax on every month. Digital payment systems have changed that arithmetic. A shopkeeper in a small town can now accept a payment in seconds, and a daily-wage labourer can send wages home before boarding the evening bus. The change is not merely one of speed. Small merchants who once kept cash under the counter now have a record of their sales, and that record can unlock a loan that a bank would never have granted to someone with no papers. Yet the shift has not been even. Poor connectivity, low literacy and the fear of fraud keep many users away, and a failed transaction at the wrong moment can cost a family a day's earnings. The sensible path is neither to force every payment online nor to dismiss digital money as a fad. It is to keep cash available while making digital rails reliable, cheap and trustworthy, so that a village does not have to choose between the old queue and the new screen. Convenience, after all, is only worth having when it is shared.

- A. A debate between two experts is presented with no resolution.
- B. A single anecdote is narrated and its moral stated in one line.
- C. Digital payment companies are compared one by one.
- D. A change is described, its benefits and gaps weighed, and a balanced way forward proposed.

Answer: D — Change, benefits, gaps, then a balanced proposal.

Trick: Spot the turn at 'Yet' — it marks the shift from gains to gaps.

Solution: The passage moves from the old queue to payments 'in seconds', turns with 'Yet the shift has not been even', and closes by proposing to keep cash and improve digital rails.

Trap: C invents a company comparison; no firm is named in the passage.

Q15. Identify the tone of the passage.

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Until a decade ago, a worker sending money home from a city had few options: a postal order, a long queue at a bank branch, or a friend travelling to the same village. The money sometimes arrived late; it rarely arrived whole. For families that lived on weekly wages, that uncertainty was a quiet tax on every month. Digital payment systems have changed that arithmetic. A shopkeeper in a small town can now accept a payment in seconds, and a daily-wage labourer can send wages home before boarding the evening bus. The change is not merely one of speed. Small merchants who once kept cash under the counter now have a record of their sales, and that record can unlock a loan that a bank would never have granted to someone with no papers. Yet the shift has not been even. Poor connectivity, low literacy and the fear of fraud keep many users away, and a failed transaction at the wrong moment can cost a family a day's earnings. The sensible path is neither to force every payment online nor to dismiss digital money as a fad. It is to keep cash available while making digital rails reliable, cheap and trustworthy, so that a village does not have to choose between the old queue and the new screen. Convenience, after all, is only worth having when it is shared.

- A. Nostalgic longing for the era of postal orders.
- B. Balanced and forward-looking, with cautious optimism.
- C. Sarcastic about village shopkeepers.
- D. Indifferent to the problems of poor connectivity.

Answer: B — Welcomes the change, names its limits, proposes fixes.

Trick: Test the tone against the closing sentence about convenience being worth having only when shared.

Solution: The passage praises the gains, lists the gaps plainly and ends on a constructive note, 'only worth having when it is shared' — balanced and forward-looking.

Trap: A misses that the author welcomes digital payments; D contradicts the detailed treatment of connectivity and fraud.

PASSAGE 4

Q16. What is the central theme of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The gig economy arrived with a promise: work whenever you like, from wherever you are, with no boss looking over your shoulder. For a young student in a metro city, delivering food between classes seemed a better bargain than a fixed shift in a shop. For a mother returning to work after a break, driving a cab on her own hours looked like freedom. But freedom has a price, and the price is usually paid in the small print. Most gig workers are classified as independent partners rather than employees, which means no fixed salary, no paid leave, no provident fund and no safety net when an accident stops the bike for a month. The app, not a manager, decides how much work arrives, and a worker who declines too many orders may quietly receive fewer. The flexibility, in other words, is real but one-sided. A worker can choose her hours, but she cannot choose the terms those hours are paid on. Some platforms have begun offering insurance and fuel bonuses; some

governments are drafting laws to guarantee minimum earnings. Neither is yet the norm. The gig economy is not going away — it answers a genuine need for both companies and workers. Yet a model that runs on the labour of people who cannot afford a single bad week must eventually answer a simple question: who carries the risk when the app closes for the night?

- A. Gig work is a fraud that should be banned outright.
- B. Students make the best food delivery workers.
- C. Apps manage work more efficiently than managers do.
- D. The gig economy offers genuine flexibility, but its risks fall unfairly on workers.

Answer: D — Flexibility is real; so is the one-sided risk.

Trick: Keep the option that pairs the promise with the small print.

Solution: The passage concedes gig work ‘answers a genuine need’, then asks ‘who carries the risk when the app closes for the night?’ — D holds both.

Trap: A overstates: the passage says the model is ‘not going away’ and needs fixing, not banning.

Q17. Which of the following facts is explicitly stated in the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The gig economy arrived with a promise: work whenever you like, from wherever you are, with no boss looking over your shoulder. For a young student in a metro city, delivering food between classes seemed a better bargain than a fixed shift in a shop. For a mother returning to work after a break, driving a cab on her own hours looked like freedom. But freedom has a price, and the price is usually paid in the small print. Most gig workers are classified as independent partners rather than employees, which means no fixed salary, no paid leave, no provident fund and no safety net when an accident stops the bike for a month. The app, not a manager, decides how much work arrives, and a worker who declines too many orders may quietly receive fewer. The flexibility, in other words, is real but one-sided. A worker can choose her hours, but she cannot choose the terms those hours are paid on. Some platforms have begun offering insurance and fuel bonuses; some governments are drafting laws to guarantee minimum earnings. Neither is yet the norm. The gig economy is not going away — it answers a genuine need for both companies and workers. Yet a model that runs on the labour of people who cannot afford a single bad week must eventually answer a simple question: who carries the risk when the app closes for the night?

- A. All gig platforms now provide health insurance.
- B. Most gig workers are classified as independent partners rather than employees.
- C. Gig workers receive paid leave after one year of service.
- D. Managers decide how much work each gig worker receives.

Answer: B — The classification that removes the safety net.

Trick: Watch quantifiers — options that say all platforms or fixed timelines go beyond the passage.

Solution: The passage states: ‘Most gig workers are classified as independent partners rather than employees’, listing no fixed salary, no paid leave, no provident fund.

Trap: D swaps the ‘app’ that decides for managers; A turns ‘Some platforms’ into a rule for all of them.

Q18. Which of the following best reflects the connection to real-life situations?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The gig economy arrived with a promise: work whenever you like, from wherever you are, with no boss looking over your shoulder. For a young student in a metro city, delivering food between classes seemed a better bargain than a fixed shift in a shop. For a mother returning to work after a break, driving a cab on her own hours looked like freedom. But freedom has a price, and the price is usually paid in the small print. Most gig workers are classified as independent partners rather than employees, which means no fixed salary, no paid leave, no provident fund and no safety net when an accident stops the bike for a month. The app, not a manager, decides how much work arrives, and a worker who declines too many orders may quietly receive fewer. The flexibility, in other words, is real but one-sided. A worker can choose her hours, but she cannot choose the terms those hours are paid on. Some platforms have begun offering insurance and fuel bonuses; some governments are drafting laws to guarantee minimum earnings. Neither is yet the norm. The gig economy is not going away — it answers a genuine need for both companies and workers. Yet a model that runs on the labour of people who cannot afford a single bad week must eventually answer a simple question: who carries the risk when the app closes for the night?

- A. A company cuts costs by hiring only part-time staff.
- B. A worker takes a second job to earn more money.
- C. A delivery rider’s family struggles because a minor accident means no income for weeks.
- D. A platform designs a faster ordering app.

Answer: C — The safety-net gap, made concrete.

Trick: Look for the situation the phrase 'no safety net' predicts.

Solution: The passage warns of 'no safety net when an accident stops the bike for a month' — C is that risk arriving in a real household.

Trap: A borrows the theme of cost-cutting but lacks the gig classification idea; B describes effort, not exposure to risk.

Q19. What is the organisational structure of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The gig economy arrived with a promise: work whenever you like, from wherever you are, with no boss looking over your shoulder. For a young student in a metro city, delivering food between classes seemed a better bargain than a fixed shift in a shop. For a mother returning to work after a break, driving a cab on her own hours looked like freedom. But freedom has a price, and the price is usually paid in the small print. Most gig workers are classified as independent partners rather than employees, which means no fixed salary, no paid leave, no provident fund and no safety net when an accident stops the bike for a month. The app, not a manager, decides how much work arrives, and a worker who declines too many orders may quietly receive fewer. The flexibility, in other words, is real but one-sided. A worker can choose her hours, but she cannot choose the terms those hours are paid on. Some platforms have begun offering insurance and fuel bonuses; some governments are drafting laws to guarantee minimum earnings. Neither is yet the norm. The gig economy is not going away — it answers a genuine need for both companies and workers. Yet a model that runs on the labour of people who cannot afford a single bad week must eventually answer a simple question: who carries the risk when the app closes for the night?

A. A promise is stated, its hidden costs are examined, and a closing question challenges the model.

B. A promise is stated, its costs are examined, and a complete solution is prescribed for all platforms.

C. Two opposing editorials are quoted and summarised.

D. Employment law is traced chronologically through history.

Answer: A — Promise, small print, then an open question.

Trick: The passage ends with a question, not a prescription — match the tail.

Solution: It opens with the promise ('work whenever you like'), exposes the small print ('no fixed salary, no paid leave'), and ends with 'who carries the risk when the app closes for the night?'

Trap: B shares the first two movements but fabricates a complete solution — the passage only notes early steps and admits 'Neither is yet the norm'.

Q20. Which of the following best describes the writing style of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The gig economy arrived with a promise: work whenever you like, from wherever you are, with no boss looking over your shoulder. For a young student in a metro city, delivering food between classes seemed a better bargain than a fixed shift in a shop. For a mother returning to work after a break, driving a cab on her own hours looked like freedom. But freedom has a price, and the price is usually paid in the small print. Most gig workers are classified as independent partners rather than employees, which means no fixed salary, no paid leave, no provident fund and no safety net when an accident stops the bike for a month. The app, not a manager, decides how much work arrives, and a worker who declines too many orders may quietly receive fewer. The flexibility, in other words, is real but one-sided. A worker can choose her hours, but she cannot choose the terms those hours are paid on. Some platforms have begun offering insurance and fuel bonuses; some governments are drafting laws to guarantee minimum earnings. Neither is yet the norm. The gig economy is not going away — it answers a genuine need for both companies and workers. Yet a model that runs on the labour of people who cannot afford a single bad week must eventually answer a simple question: who carries the risk when the app closes for the night?

A. Detached and clinical, avoiding human examples.

B. Poetic and lyrical, with no argumentative thread.

C. Aggressive and accusatory, blaming workers.

D. Accessible and argumentative, mixing everyday examples with economic reasoning.

Answer: D — Everyday faces, hard economics.

Trick: Style = how it argues: whose stories, which vocabulary.

Solution: The passage uses everyday figures ('delivering food between classes', a mother driving a cab) and plain economics ('no provident fund'), building an argument — accessible and argumentative.

Trap: A ignores the human examples; C misreads the sympathy for the workers as blame.

PASSAGE 5

Q21. What is the central theme of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Mangroves look untidy from a distance — a tangle of stilt roots and dark water that seems to promise nothing but mosquitoes. Coastal planners once shared that impression and cleared vast stretches for shrimp ponds, resorts and ports. The storms of recent years have forced a second look. Where mangroves stand, they blunt the force of cyclones: their roots slow incoming waves, hold soil in place and soak up floodwater like a natural barrier that costs nothing to maintain. Villages behind healthy mangrove belts report less flooding and fewer breaches than those behind bare seawalls. Where a wall reflects a wave, a forest absorbs it, and the difference is measured in saved houses. The trees are also nurseries; young fish and prawns shelter among the roots before moving to open water, which quietly supports the catch of small fishing families. However, planting mangroves is not as simple as scattering seeds. The wrong species in the wrong mudflat can die within a season, and restored patches need years of protection before they can face a storm on their own. The most effective programmes begin with what local fishers already know about tides and creeks, and end with community rules that keep cattle and trawlers away. Protection, not planting alone, is what turns a mudflat back into a shield. A coastline, after all, remembers every tree that was taken from it.

A. Mangroves are unattractive and of little practical use.

B. Shrimp farming should be banned along every coast.

C. Mangroves shield coasts and nurture fisheries, so restoring and protecting them pays.

D. Seawalls are useless in every situation.

Answer: C — A shield and a nursery worth protecting.

Trick: Reject options that turn comparisons into absolutes.

Solution: The passage shows mangroves ‘blunt the force of cyclones’ and shelter young fish, concluding that protection ‘turns a mudflat back into a shield’.

Trap: D overstates: the passage compares mangrove belts with bare seawalls but never calls seawalls useless everywhere.

Q22. Which of the following facts is explicitly stated in the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Mangroves look untidy from a distance — a tangle of stilt roots and dark water that seems to promise nothing but mosquitoes. Coastal planners once shared that impression and cleared vast stretches for shrimp ponds, resorts and ports. The storms of recent years have forced a second look. Where mangroves stand, they blunt the force of cyclones: their roots slow incoming waves, hold soil in place and soak up floodwater like a natural barrier that costs nothing to maintain. Villages behind healthy mangrove belts report less flooding and fewer breaches than those behind bare seawalls. Where a wall reflects a wave, a forest absorbs it, and the difference is measured in saved houses. The trees are also nurseries; young fish and prawns shelter among the roots before moving to open water, which quietly supports the catch of small fishing families. However, planting mangroves is not as simple as scattering seeds. The wrong species in the wrong mudflat can die within a season, and restored patches need years of protection before they can face a storm on their own. The most effective programmes begin with what local fishers already know about tides and creeks, and end with community rules that keep cattle and trawlers away. Protection, not planting alone, is what turns a mudflat back into a shield. A coastline, after all, remembers every tree that was taken from it.

A. Villages behind healthy mangrove belts report less flooding than those behind bare seawalls.

B. Mangrove planting always succeeds when seeds are scattered.

C. Mangroves grow best in dry, sandy soil.

D. Trawlers help restored patches by stirring the mud.

Answer: A — A direct comparison from the passage.

Trick: Find the sentence with two villages and two defences.

Solution: The passage states: ‘Villages behind healthy mangrove belts report less flooding and fewer breaches than those behind bare seawalls.’

Trap: B inverts ‘not as simple as scattering seeds’; D reverses the rule that keeps ‘cattle and trawlers away’.

Q23. Which of the following best reflects the connection to real-life situations?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Mangroves look untidy from a distance — a tangle of stilt roots and dark water that seems to promise nothing but mosquitoes. Coastal planners once shared that impression and cleared vast stretches for shrimp ponds, resorts and ports. The storms of recent years have forced a second look. Where mangroves stand, they blunt the force of cyclones: their roots slow incoming waves, hold soil in place and soak up floodwater like a natural barrier that costs nothing to maintain. Villages behind healthy mangrove belts report less flooding and fewer breaches than those behind bare seawalls. Where a wall reflects a wave, a forest absorbs it, and the

difference is measured in saved houses. The trees are also nurseries; young fish and prawns shelter among the roots before moving to open water, which quietly supports the catch of small fishing families. However, planting mangroves is not as simple as scattering seeds. The wrong species in the wrong mudflat can die within a season, and restored patches need years of protection before they can face a storm on their own. The most effective programmes begin with what local fishers already know about tides and creeks, and end with community rules that keep cattle and trawlers away. Protection, not planting alone, is what turns a mudflat back into a shield. A coastline, after all, remembers every tree that was taken from it.

- A. A resort clears mangrove roots to build a sea-facing lawn.
- B. A fishing village restores its creek-side mangroves and sets community rules to keep them safe.
- C. A city builds a taller seawall and abandons its mudflats.
- D. A farmer plants mango trees along a riverbank.

Answer: B — Local knowledge plus protection rules, as advised.

Trick: Choose the option that combines planting with protection — the two-part recipe of the passage.

Solution: The passage says effective programmes 'begin with what local fishers already know about tides and creeks' and end with rules keeping 'cattle and trawlers away' — B is that programme.

Trap: D tempts by sound alone: mango trees are not mangroves, and a riverbank is not a mudflat.

Q24. What is the organisational structure of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Mangroves look untidy from a distance — a tangle of stilt roots and dark water that seems to promise nothing but mosquitoes. Coastal planners once shared that impression and cleared vast stretches for shrimp ponds, resorts and ports. The storms of recent years have forced a second look. Where mangroves stand, they blunt the force of cyclones: their roots slow incoming waves, hold soil in place and soak up floodwater like a natural barrier that costs nothing to maintain. Villages behind healthy mangrove belts report less flooding and fewer breaches than those behind bare seawalls. Where a wall reflects a wave, a forest absorbs it, and the difference is measured in saved houses. The trees are also nurseries; young fish and prawns shelter among the roots before moving to open water, which quietly supports the catch of small fishing families. However, planting mangroves is not as simple as scattering seeds. The wrong species in the wrong mudflat can die within a season, and restored patches need years of protection before they can face a storm on their own. The most effective programmes begin with what local fishers already know about tides and creeks, and end with community rules that keep cattle and trawlers away. Protection, not planting alone, is what turns a mudflat back into a shield. A coastline, after all, remembers every tree that was taken from it.

- A. A chronology of storm disasters is narrated year by year.
- B. Two experts debate seawalls and no view prevails.
- C. A problem is stated and three technologies are compared.
- D. A false impression is corrected, benefits are explained, and practical advice closes the passage.

Answer: D — Impression, correction, benefits, advice.

Trick: Note the turn at 'forced a second look' — it flips the opening impression.

Solution: The passage opens with the untidy first impression, corrects it ('The storms of recent years have forced a second look'), explains the benefits, and closes with advice on protection.

Trap: C imports a technology comparison; the passage discusses one natural defence, not rival machines.

Q25. Choose the word most nearly SIMILAR in meaning to 'blunt' as used in the passage.

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Mangroves look untidy from a distance — a tangle of stilt roots and dark water that seems to promise nothing but mosquitoes. Coastal planners once shared that impression and cleared vast stretches for shrimp ponds, resorts and ports. The storms of recent years have forced a second look. Where mangroves stand, they blunt the force of cyclones: their roots slow incoming waves, hold soil in place and soak up floodwater like a natural barrier that costs nothing to maintain. Villages behind healthy mangrove belts report less flooding and fewer breaches than those behind bare seawalls. Where a wall reflects a wave, a forest absorbs it, and the difference is measured in saved houses. The trees are also nurseries; young fish and prawns shelter among the roots before moving to open water, which quietly supports the catch of small fishing families. However, planting mangroves is not as simple as scattering seeds. The wrong species in the wrong mudflat can die within a season, and restored patches need years of protection before they can face a storm on their own. The most effective programmes begin with what local fishers already know about tides and creeks, and end with community rules that keep cattle and trawlers away. Protection, not planting alone, is what turns a mudflat back into a shield. A coastline, after all, remembers every tree that was taken from it.

- A. dull
- B. absorb

- C. weaken
- D. sharpen

Answer: C — Blunt here is a verb: to take the force out of something.

Trick: Ask what mangroves do to cyclones — they reduce the force.

Solution: 'they blunt the force of cyclones' — the roots slow waves and hold soil, so blunt means weaken or reduce.

Trap: A is the everyday sense of blunt (not sharp), which is not what mangroves do to storms; D is the opposite of the required meaning.

PASSAGE 6

Q26. What is the central theme of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Every handloom saree carries a small arithmetic that few buyers notice. A weaver spends days at the loom, but the yarn, dye and middlemen together take most of the price the saree finally commands. For decades, this arithmetic pushed weaving families towards powerlooms and city jobs, and many feared the craft would survive only in museum displays. Yet the last few years have brought an unexpected turn. Online marketplaces now let weavers sell directly to buyers, festival exhibitions have become fashionable again, and a new generation of designers treats handloom cloth as a luxury rather than a leftover. A buyer who once asked for the cheapest cloth now asks for the name of the weaver. Sales have risen, and some young people who once left the village have returned to the loom. However, revival is not the same as security. Direct selling still demands skills — photography, pricing, English — that many weavers lack, and a single viral season does not pay for a year at the loom. The lasting fix is unglamorous: fair prices at the first sale, steady orders, and credit that reaches the weaver rather than the trader. A craft survives, after all, not because it is admired in a gallery, but because it can feed the family that practises it.

- A. Handloom weaving should survive only in museum displays.
- B. Handloom weaving is reviving, but weavers still need fair prices and steady support.
- C. Online marketplaces have solved every problem weavers face.
- D. Powerlooms produce better cloth than handlooms.

Answer: B — A real revival, an unfinished problem.

Trick: Match the double move of the passage: 'Yet' for revival, 'However' for caution.

Solution: The passage reports rising sales and returning weavers, then insists 'revival is not the same as security' and lists fair prices, steady orders and credit — B captures both.

Trap: C overstates: direct selling still demands skills 'that many weavers lack'.

Q27. Which of the following facts is explicitly stated in the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Every handloom saree carries a small arithmetic that few buyers notice. A weaver spends days at the loom, but the yarn, dye and middlemen together take most of the price the saree finally commands. For decades, this arithmetic pushed weaving families towards powerlooms and city jobs, and many feared the craft would survive only in museum displays. Yet the last few years have brought an unexpected turn. Online marketplaces now let weavers sell directly to buyers, festival exhibitions have become fashionable again, and a new generation of designers treats handloom cloth as a luxury rather than a leftover. A buyer who once asked for the cheapest cloth now asks for the name of the weaver. Sales have risen, and some young people who once left the village have returned to the loom. However, revival is not the same as security. Direct selling still demands skills — photography, pricing, English — that many weavers lack, and a single viral season does not pay for a year at the loom. The lasting fix is unglamorous: fair prices at the first sale, steady orders, and credit that reaches the weaver rather than the trader. A craft survives, after all, not because it is admired in a gallery, but because it can feed the family that practises it.

- A. Weavers keep most of the price a saree commands.
- B. Festival exhibitions have lost their popularity.
- C. Some young people who once left the village have returned to the loom.
- D. Direct selling requires no new skills.

Answer: C — The human sign of revival.

Trick: Three options contradict the words of the passage; only one repeats them.

Solution: The passage states that 'some young people who once left the village have returned to the loom'.

Trap: A reverses the arithmetic — 'yarn, dye and middlemen together take most of the price'; B flips 'have become fashionable again'.

Q28. Which of the following best reflects the connection to real-life situations?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Every handloom saree carries a small arithmetic that few buyers notice. A weaver spends days at the loom, but the yarn, dye and middlemen together take most of the price the saree finally commands. For decades, this arithmetic pushed weaving families towards powerlooms and city jobs, and many feared the craft would survive only in museum displays. Yet the last few years have brought an unexpected turn. Online marketplaces now let weavers sell directly to buyers, festival exhibitions have become fashionable again, and a new generation of designers treats handloom cloth as a luxury rather than a leftover. A buyer who once asked for the cheapest cloth now asks for the name of the weaver. Sales have risen, and some young people who once left the village have returned to the loom. However, revival is not the same as security. Direct selling still demands skills — photography, pricing, English — that many weavers lack, and a single viral season does not pay for a year at the loom. The lasting fix is unglamorous: fair prices at the first sale, steady orders, and credit that reaches the weaver rather than the trader. A craft survives, after all, not because it is admired in a gallery, but because it can feed the family that practises it.

A. A museum displays antique looms behind glass.

B. A brand prints handloom labels on powerloom cloth.

C. A weaver abandons the loom for a city job.

D. A cooperative pays weavers upfront and books their next season of orders.

Answer: D — Fair price at the first sale plus steady orders.

Trick: Convert the wish list of the passage into a real transaction.

Solution: The 'lasting fix' in the passage is 'fair prices at the first sale, steady orders, and credit that reaches the weaver' — D delivers exactly these.

Trap: A is the fate the weavers feared, not the solution; B imitates the label without the loom.

Q29. What is the organisational structure of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Every handloom saree carries a small arithmetic that few buyers notice. A weaver spends days at the loom, but the yarn, dye and middlemen together take most of the price the saree finally commands. For decades, this arithmetic pushed weaving families towards powerlooms and city jobs, and many feared the craft would survive only in museum displays. Yet the last few years have brought an unexpected turn. Online marketplaces now let weavers sell directly to buyers, festival exhibitions have become fashionable again, and a new generation of designers treats handloom cloth as a luxury rather than a leftover. A buyer who once asked for the cheapest cloth now asks for the name of the weaver. Sales have risen, and some young people who once left the village have returned to the loom. However, revival is not the same as security. Direct selling still demands skills — photography, pricing, English — that many weavers lack, and a single viral season does not pay for a year at the loom. The lasting fix is unglamorous: fair prices at the first sale, steady orders, and credit that reaches the weaver rather than the trader. A craft survives, after all, not because it is admired in a gallery, but because it can feed the family that practises it.

A. A hidden problem is described, a revival is noted, and conditions for lasting survival are listed.

B. A problem is described, a revival is noted, and the passage declares the problem solved.

C. The history of textiles is narrated century by century.

D. Two weavers tell their stories and the author adds no comment.

Answer: A — Problem, revival, conditions.

Trick: The tail is a checklist, not a victory lap.

Solution: The passage shows the price arithmetic, the 'unexpected turn' of revival, and closes with the 'unglamorous' conditions for survival.

Trap: B matches the first two movements but the passage insists revival 'is not the same as security'.

Q30. Identify the tone of the passage.

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Every handloom saree carries a small arithmetic that few buyers notice. A weaver spends days at the loom, but the yarn, dye and middlemen together take most of the price the saree finally commands. For decades, this arithmetic pushed weaving families towards powerlooms and city jobs, and many feared the craft would survive only in museum displays. Yet the last few years have brought an unexpected turn. Online marketplaces now let weavers sell directly to buyers, festival exhibitions have become fashionable again, and a new generation of designers treats handloom cloth as a luxury rather than a leftover. A buyer who once asked for the cheapest cloth now asks for the name of the weaver. Sales have risen, and some young people who once left the village have returned to the loom. However, revival is not the same as security. Direct selling still demands skills — photography, pricing, English — that many weavers lack, and a single viral season does not pay for a year at the loom. The lasting fix is unglamorous: fair prices at the first sale, steady orders, and credit that

reaches the weaver rather than the trader. A craft survives, after all, not because it is admired in a gallery, but because it can feed the family that practises it.

- A. Triumphant, celebrating an unqualified victory.
- B. Hopeful but sober, mindful of unfinished problems.
- C. Despairing and resigned to the death of the craft.
- D. Mocking the taste of urban buyers.

Answer: B — Glad of the revival, clear-eyed about its fragility.

Trick: Weigh the two turns: hope at 'Yet', caution at 'However'.

Solution: The passage welcomes the 'unexpected turn' but warns that a 'single viral season does not pay for a year at the loom' — hopeful yet sober.

Trap: A ignores the caution; C ignores the revival; D finds no mockery in a passage that respects buyers and weavers alike.

PASSAGE 7

Q31. What is the central theme of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A country can grow enough grain and still go hungry. For years, food security was measured by the size of the harvest and the level of buffer stocks, and by that yardstick the numbers looked reassuring. Granaries filled, exports rose, and famine in the classical sense receded. But a full plate is not the same as a balanced one. Surveys began to show a different problem: families eating rice or wheat in quantity while vegetables, pulses, milk and fruit slipped out of reach. A family can eat two full plates a day and still send a stunted child to school. The result is what nutritionists call hidden hunger — enough calories, too few nutrients — which stunts children, weakens adults and quietly drains the economy. Fixing this cannot be done by growing more of the same crop. It needs a wider basket: millets and pulses on the farm, fruit and vegetables in the market, clean water and better sanitation at home, and school meals that teach as they feed. Some states have shown that a midday meal with greens, eggs and milk changes both attendance and attention in the classroom. The harvest, in short, is only half the story. A nation is food-secure when its people are not just fed, but nourished.

- A. Food security means nutrition, not merely grain output.
- B. Granaries and buffer stocks should be abolished.
- C. Grain exports are the best measure of a nation of plenty.
- D. Rice is the most nutritious cereal.

Answer: A — Full granaries can still mean empty nutrition.

Trick: Keep the option that separates 'fed' from 'nourished'.

Solution: The passage ends 'not just fed, but nourished' and calls hidden hunger the real problem — A is that whole argument.

Trap: C uses the yardstick of the passage but stops where the passage says the story continues; B attacks stores the passage never condemns.

Q32. Which of the following facts is explicitly stated in the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A country can grow enough grain and still go hungry. For years, food security was measured by the size of the harvest and the level of buffer stocks, and by that yardstick the numbers looked reassuring. Granaries filled, exports rose, and famine in the classical sense receded. But a full plate is not the same as a balanced one. Surveys began to show a different problem: families eating rice or wheat in quantity while vegetables, pulses, milk and fruit slipped out of reach. A family can eat two full plates a day and still send a stunted child to school. The result is what nutritionists call hidden hunger — enough calories, too few nutrients — which stunts children, weakens adults and quietly drains the economy. Fixing this cannot be done by growing more of the same crop. It needs a wider basket: millets and pulses on the farm, fruit and vegetables in the market, clean water and better sanitation at home, and school meals that teach as they feed. Some states have shown that a midday meal with greens, eggs and milk changes both attendance and attention in the classroom. The harvest, in short, is only half the story. A nation is food-secure when its people are not just fed, but nourished.

- A. Famine has increased in recent years.
- B. Hidden hunger is caused by too few calories.
- C. Midday meals reduce school attendance.
- D. Hidden hunger stunts children and weakens adults.

Answer: D — The consequences named in the definition.

Trick: Hidden hunger is defined in the passage — find the consequences in that definition.

Solution: The passage defines hidden hunger as 'enough calories, too few nutrients' and says it 'stunts children, weakens adults and quietly drains the economy'.

Trap: B inverts the first half of the definition; C flips 'changes both attendance and attention' into a fall.

Q33. Which of the following best reflects the connection to real-life situations?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A country can grow enough grain and still go hungry. For years, food security was measured by the size of the harvest and the level of buffer stocks, and by that yardstick the numbers looked reassuring. Granaries filled, exports rose, and famine in the classical sense receded. But a full plate is not the same as a balanced one. Surveys began to show a different problem: families eating rice or wheat in quantity while vegetables, pulses, milk and fruit slipped out of reach. A family can eat two full plates a day and still send a stunted child to school. The result is what nutritionists call hidden hunger — enough calories, too few nutrients — which stunts children, weakens adults and quietly drains the economy. Fixing this cannot be done by growing more of the same crop. It needs a wider basket: millets and pulses on the farm, fruit and vegetables in the market, clean water and better sanitation at home, and school meals that teach as they feed. Some states have shown that a midday meal with greens, eggs and milk changes both attendance and attention in the classroom. The harvest, in short, is only half the story. A nation is food-secure when its people are not just fed, but nourished.

A. A district counts its granaries and declares itself food-secure while anaemia surveys are shelved.

B. A school midday meal adds greens, eggs and milk, and classroom attention improves.

C. A family eats more rice to feel full.

D. A government exports more grain to earn foreign exchange.

Answer: B — The example of the passage, applied to a classroom.

Trick: The application must nourish, not just fill.

Solution: The passage notes that a midday meal 'with greens, eggs and milk changes both attendance and attention' — B is that principle in action.

Trap: A repeats the error the passage warns against, dressed in the vocabulary of the passage; D measures success by exports, the old yardstick.

Q34. What is the organisational structure of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A country can grow enough grain and still go hungry. For years, food security was measured by the size of the harvest and the level of buffer stocks, and by that yardstick the numbers looked reassuring. Granaries filled, exports rose, and famine in the classical sense receded. But a full plate is not the same as a balanced one. Surveys began to show a different problem: families eating rice or wheat in quantity while vegetables, pulses, milk and fruit slipped out of reach. A family can eat two full plates a day and still send a stunted child to school. The result is what nutritionists call hidden hunger — enough calories, too few nutrients — which stunts children, weakens adults and quietly drains the economy. Fixing this cannot be done by growing more of the same crop. It needs a wider basket: millets and pulses on the farm, fruit and vegetables in the market, clean water and better sanitation at home, and school meals that teach as they feed. Some states have shown that a midday meal with greens, eggs and milk changes both attendance and attention in the classroom. The harvest, in short, is only half the story. A nation is food-secure when its people are not just fed, but nourished.

A. Two rival definitions are debated and neither is accepted.

B. A chronology of famines is narrated.

C. An old measure is stated, its limits are exposed, and a broader approach is urged.

D. A scientific experiment is described and its results tabulated.

Answer: C — Old yardstick, its blind spot, a wider basket.

Trick: Find the turn at 'But' — it splits the old measure from the new one.

Solution: The passage sets out the harvest-and-stocks yardstick, turns at 'But a full plate is not the same as a balanced one', and urges a 'wider basket'.

Trap: A invents a debate; the passage builds one continuous argument.

Q35. Which of the following best describes the writing style of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A country can grow enough grain and still go hungry. For years, food security was measured by the size of the harvest and the level of buffer stocks, and by that yardstick the numbers looked reassuring. Granaries filled,

exports rose, and famine in the classical sense receded. But a full plate is not the same as a balanced one. Surveys began to show a different problem: families eating rice or wheat in quantity while vegetables, pulses, milk and fruit slipped out of reach. A family can eat two full plates a day and still send a stunted child to school. The result is what nutritionists call hidden hunger — enough calories, too few nutrients — which stunts children, weakens adults and quietly drains the economy. Fixing this cannot be done by growing more of the same crop. It needs a wider basket: millets and pulses on the farm, fruit and vegetables in the market, clean water and better sanitation at home, and school meals that teach as they feed. Some states have shown that a midday meal with greens, eggs and milk changes both attendance and attention in the classroom. The harvest, in short, is only half the story. A nation is food-secure when its people are not just fed, but nourished.

- A. Argumentative and evidence-based, using contrasts to sharpen the point.
- B. Purely descriptive, listing foods without any argument.
- C. Humorous and anecdotal, avoiding statistics entirely.
- D. Poetic and emotional, appealing only to sentiment.

Answer: A — Contrasts carry the case.

Trick: Style shows in the hinges: 'But', 'not the same as', 'only half the story'.

Solution: The passage argues through contrasts — 'enough calories, too few nutrients', 'not just fed, but nourished' — citing survey findings, so A fits.

Trap: B ignores the argument; D ignores the evidence and the cool tone.

PASSAGE 8

Q36. What is the central theme of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A library card once opened exactly one kind of door: a room of shelves where silence was the house rule. That world has not disappeared, but it has changed shape. Many public libraries now lend e-books and audiobooks, run coding classes and offer quiet corners with free internet for students who have no study table at home. For a reader in a small town, a library membership can now mean access to thousands of titles that no local bookshop could stock. The same card that opened a reading room now opens a reference shelf the size of a city. Librarians, far from becoming obsolete, have turned into guides — helping elderly readers load a book onto a phone and children find a story in a language they are still learning. However, the transition is fragile. Budgets are stretched, digital licences cost more than print copies, and a library that is only a screen can lose the very readers it hoped to attract. The healthiest libraries are hybrids: shelves for browsing, terminals for searching, and staff who know both. In a noisy, distracted age, a quiet room with a chair, a lamp and a librarian who remembers your name is not nostalgia; it is infrastructure for attention. Reading, after all, has never been only about words. It is also about the place that gives them room.

- A. Printed books are obsolete and should leave libraries.
- B. Librarians will soon be replaced by software.
- C. E-books are too expensive to be worth lending.
- D. Public libraries are evolving into hybrid spaces that blend print, digital access and human guidance.

Answer: D — Shelves, screens and staff, together.

Trick: The closing image — 'the place that gives them room' — points to the hybrid.

Solution: The passage describes libraries lending e-books, running classes and keeping 'shelves for browsing, terminals for searching, and staff who know both' — D is that hybrid.

Trap: C lifts the cost fact but drops the conclusion of the passage; A and B contradict 'far from becoming obsolete'.

Q37. Which of the following facts is explicitly stated in the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A library card once opened exactly one kind of door: a room of shelves where silence was the house rule. That world has not disappeared, but it has changed shape. Many public libraries now lend e-books and audiobooks, run coding classes and offer quiet corners with free internet for students who have no study table at home. For a reader in a small town, a library membership can now mean access to thousands of titles that no local bookshop could stock. The same card that opened a reading room now opens a reference shelf the size of a city. Librarians, far from becoming obsolete, have turned into guides — helping elderly readers load a book onto a phone and children find a story in a language they are still learning. However, the transition is fragile. Budgets are stretched, digital licences cost more than print copies, and a library that is only a screen can lose the very readers it hoped to attract. The healthiest libraries are hybrids: shelves for browsing, terminals for searching, and staff who know both. In a noisy, distracted age, a quiet room with a chair, a

lamp and a librarian who remembers your name is not nostalgia; it is infrastructure for attention. Reading, after all, has never been only about words. It is also about the place that gives them room.

- A. Libraries have stopped lending printed books.
- B. Digital licences cost less than print copies.
- C. Libraries run coding classes and offer free internet.
- D. Library budgets have grown in recent years.

Answer: C — A direct inventory of new services.

Trick: Check each claim against the sentence on services; only one is verbatim.

Solution: The passage states libraries 'run coding classes and offer quiet corners with free internet for students'.

Trap: B reverses the cost comparison; D contradicts 'Budgets are stretched'.

Q38. Which of the following best reflects the connection to real-life situations?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A library card once opened exactly one kind of door: a room of shelves where silence was the house rule. That world has not disappeared, but it has changed shape. Many public libraries now lend e-books and audiobooks, run coding classes and offer quiet corners with free internet for students who have no study table at home. For a reader in a small town, a library membership can now mean access to thousands of titles that no local bookshop could stock. The same card that opened a reading room now opens a reference shelf the size of a city. Librarians, far from becoming obsolete, have turned into guides — helping elderly readers load a book onto a phone and children find a story in a language they are still learning. However, the transition is fragile. Budgets are stretched, digital licences cost more than print copies, and a library that is only a screen can lose the very readers it hoped to attract. The healthiest libraries are hybrids: shelves for browsing, terminals for searching, and staff who know both. In a noisy, distracted age, a quiet room with a chair, a lamp and a librarian who remembers your name is not nostalgia; it is infrastructure for attention. Reading, after all, has never been only about words. It is also about the place that gives them room.

- A. A small-town library keeps its shelves, adds an e-book corner and helps first-time readers sign in.
- B. A library removes all printed books to save space.
- C. A reader downloads every book at home and stops visiting the library.
- D. A librarian refuses to help elderly users with devices.

Answer: A — Print kept, digital added, staff guiding.

Trick: Pick the option where all three strands — shelves, screens, staff — survive.

Solution: The healthy library of the passage is a hybrid of 'shelves for browsing, terminals for searching, and staff who know both'; A mirrors that balance in one small town.

Trap: B chooses the screen-only model the passage warns 'can lose the very readers it hoped to attract'.

Q39. What is the organisational structure of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A library card once opened exactly one kind of door: a room of shelves where silence was the house rule. That world has not disappeared, but it has changed shape. Many public libraries now lend e-books and audiobooks, run coding classes and offer quiet corners with free internet for students who have no study table at home. For a reader in a small town, a library membership can now mean access to thousands of titles that no local bookshop could stock. The same card that opened a reading room now opens a reference shelf the size of a city. Librarians, far from becoming obsolete, have turned into guides — helping elderly readers load a book onto a phone and children find a story in a language they are still learning. However, the transition is fragile. Budgets are stretched, digital licences cost more than print copies, and a library that is only a screen can lose the very readers it hoped to attract. The healthiest libraries are hybrids: shelves for browsing, terminals for searching, and staff who know both. In a noisy, distracted age, a quiet room with a chair, a lamp and a librarian who remembers your name is not nostalgia; it is infrastructure for attention. Reading, after all, has never been only about words. It is also about the place that gives them room.

- A. A debate among readers is described and left unresolved.
- B. An old picture is contrasted with the present, challenges are noted, and a balanced model is endorsed.
- C. A single annual report of a library is summarised.
- D. The history of printing is traced from its invention.

Answer: B — Then, now, strains, then the hybrid.

Trick: The first sentence paints the library of the past; the last endorses the hybrid.

Solution: The passage opens with the library card of the past, when 'silence was the house rule', contrasts it with today, notes stretched budgets, and endorses the hybrid — B matches exactly.

Trap: D reaches far back beyond the frame of the passage; the passage contrasts one past with one present, not a

full history.

Q40. Choose the word most nearly OPPOSITE in meaning to 'obsolete' as used in the passage.

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A library card once opened exactly one kind of door: a room of shelves where silence was the house rule. That world has not disappeared, but it has changed shape. Many public libraries now lend e-books and audiobooks, run coding classes and offer quiet corners with free internet for students who have no study table at home. For a reader in a small town, a library membership can now mean access to thousands of titles that no local bookshop could stock. The same card that opened a reading room now opens a reference shelf the size of a city. Librarians, far from becoming obsolete, have turned into guides — helping elderly readers load a book onto a phone and children find a story in a language they are still learning. However, the transition is fragile. Budgets are stretched, digital licences cost more than print copies, and a library that is only a screen can lose the very readers it hoped to attract. The healthiest libraries are hybrids: shelves for browsing, terminals for searching, and staff who know both. In a noisy, distracted age, a quiet room with a chair, a lamp and a librarian who remembers your name is not nostalgia; it is infrastructure for attention. Reading, after all, has never been only about words. It is also about the place that gives them room.

- A. ancient
- B. useful
- C. expensive
- D. modern

Answer: D — Not obsolete means still current.

Trick: Librarians are 'far from becoming obsolete' — that is, they remain needed now.

Solution: The passage says librarians are 'far from becoming obsolete' as they turn into guides; the opposite of no longer needed is current or modern.

Trap: A is a near-synonym of obsolete, tempting those who miss the word OPPOSITE; B pulls from the usefulness of librarians, which is not an antonym of the word itself.

PASSAGE 9

Q41. What is the central theme of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A coral reef is easy to mistake for a collection of rocks. In truth it is a city built by millions of tiny animals, each no bigger than a grain of rice, that secrete limestone around themselves and live in partnership with algae that give the reef its colour. That partnership is also its weakness. When the sea grows too warm, the algae leave, the coral turns ghostly white, and unless the water cools quickly, the city begins to die. A bleached reef is not yet dead, but it is a city under evacuation. Warming seas have already bleached reefs across the tropics, and scientists warn that without rapid action, most reefs could be lost within a few decades. Yet the story is not one of helplessness. Some corals have shown an unexpected tolerance for heat, and marine parks that curb overfishing and pollution give reefs the breathing space to recover. Researchers are breeding heat-resistant strains and replanting damaged patches, much as foresters replant a hillside. None of this is a substitute for cutting the emissions that warm the sea in the first place. But it can buy time — and in conservation, time is the one resource that lets everything else recover. A reef, like any city, can be rebuilt if its residents are given room to return.

- A. Coral reefs are merely lifeless rock formations.
- B. Coral reefs are fragile living cities threatened by warming seas, and focused action can buy them time.
- C. Marine parks are the only solution to a warming sea.
- D. Algae are the destroyers of the reefs of the world.

Answer: B — A city of tiny builders, a warming threat, time bought by action.

Trick: Reject absolutes — the passage is precise about what each remedy can and cannot do.

Solution: The passage calls the reef 'a city built by millions of tiny animals', shows its bleaching, and says remedies 'can buy time' while emissions cuts remain essential — B holds all three.

Trap: C overstates: the passage says none of the remedies 'is a substitute for cutting the emissions'.

Q42. Which of the following facts is explicitly stated in the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A coral reef is easy to mistake for a collection of rocks. In truth it is a city built by millions of tiny animals, each no bigger than a grain of rice, that secrete limestone around themselves and live in partnership with algae that give the reef its colour. That partnership is also its weakness. When the sea grows too warm, the algae leave, the coral turns ghostly white, and unless the water cools quickly, the city begins to die. A

bleached reef is not yet dead, but it is a city under evacuation. Warming seas have already bleached reefs across the tropics, and scientists warn that without rapid action, most reefs could be lost within a few decades. Yet the story is not one of helplessness. Some corals have shown an unexpected tolerance for heat, and marine parks that curb overfishing and pollution give reefs the breathing space to recover. Researchers are breeding heat-resistant strains and replanting damaged patches, much as foresters replant a hillside. None of this is a substitute for cutting the emissions that warm the sea in the first place. But it can buy time — and in conservation, time is the one resource that lets everything else recover. A reef, like any city, can be rebuilt if its residents are given room to return.

- A. When the sea grows warm, the algae leave and the coral turns white.
- B. Corals build their homes from grains of sand.
- C. Every coral dies as soon as the water warms.
- D. Researchers have stopped replanting damaged reefs.

Answer: A — The bleaching sequence, step by step.

Trick: Track the sentence beginning 'When the sea grows too warm'.

Solution: The passage states: 'the algae leave, the coral turns ghostly white' — A is this sequence exactly.

Trap: B borrows 'a grain of rice', which describes the size of the animals, not their building material; C ignores corals with 'an unexpected tolerance for heat'.

Q43. Which of the following best reflects the connection to real-life situations?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A coral reef is easy to mistake for a collection of rocks. In truth it is a city built by millions of tiny animals, each no bigger than a grain of rice, that secrete limestone around themselves and live in partnership with algae that give the reef its colour. That partnership is also its weakness. When the sea grows too warm, the algae leave, the coral turns ghostly white, and unless the water cools quickly, the city begins to die. A bleached reef is not yet dead, but it is a city under evacuation. Warming seas have already bleached reefs across the tropics, and scientists warn that without rapid action, most reefs could be lost within a few decades. Yet the story is not one of helplessness. Some corals have shown an unexpected tolerance for heat, and marine parks that curb overfishing and pollution give reefs the breathing space to recover. Researchers are breeding heat-resistant strains and replanting damaged patches, much as foresters replant a hillside. None of this is a substitute for cutting the emissions that warm the sea in the first place. But it can buy time — and in conservation, time is the one resource that lets everything else recover. A reef, like any city, can be rebuilt if its residents are given room to return.

- A. A resort sells pieces of dead coral as souvenirs.
- B. A city bans fishing near a reef but lets untreated sewage flow in.
- C. A marine park limits fishing and replants heat-resistant corals while its country also cuts emissions.
- D. A student writes an essay on coral without visiting one.

Answer: C — Relief work plus the root cause.

Trick: The remedies of the passage are necessary but not sufficient — find the option that also addresses warming.

Solution: The passage endorses marine parks that 'curb overfishing and pollution' and replanting, but insists on 'cutting the emissions that warm the sea'; C does both.

Trap: B half-follows the advice — the passage pairs pollution with overfishing, and untreated sewage is the pollution it names.

Q44. What is the organisational structure of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A coral reef is easy to mistake for a collection of rocks. In truth it is a city built by millions of tiny animals, each no bigger than a grain of rice, that secrete limestone around themselves and live in partnership with algae that give the reef its colour. That partnership is also its weakness. When the sea grows too warm, the algae leave, the coral turns ghostly white, and unless the water cools quickly, the city begins to die. A bleached reef is not yet dead, but it is a city under evacuation. Warming seas have already bleached reefs across the tropics, and scientists warn that without rapid action, most reefs could be lost within a few decades. Yet the story is not one of helplessness. Some corals have shown an unexpected tolerance for heat, and marine parks that curb overfishing and pollution give reefs the breathing space to recover. Researchers are breeding heat-resistant strains and replanting damaged patches, much as foresters replant a hillside. None of this is a substitute for cutting the emissions that warm the sea in the first place. But it can buy time — and in conservation, time is the one resource that lets everything else recover. A reef, like any city, can be rebuilt if its residents are given room to return.

- A. A travelogue describes a reef and ends with a poem.
- B. Two scientists debate the age of reefs.

- C. A problem is stated and one dramatic solution is presented as sufficient.
D. The nature of reefs is explained, their vulnerability shown, and realistic remedies balanced against the root cause.

Answer: D — What reefs are, what threatens them, what helps.

Trick: The turn at 'Yet' opens the remedies; the closing lines rank them honestly.

Solution: The passage explains the partnership of the reef, traces bleaching, then presents remedies that 'can buy time' without replacing emissions cuts — D is that balance.

Trap: C gets the problem right but claims a single sufficient fix, which the passage explicitly denies.

Q45. Identify the tone of the passage.

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A coral reef is easy to mistake for a collection of rocks. In truth it is a city built by millions of tiny animals, each no bigger than a grain of rice, that secrete limestone around themselves and live in partnership with algae that give the reef its colour. That partnership is also its weakness. When the sea grows too warm, the algae leave, the coral turns ghostly white, and unless the water cools quickly, the city begins to die. A bleached reef is not yet dead, but it is a city under evacuation. Warming seas have already bleached reefs across the tropics, and scientists warn that without rapid action, most reefs could be lost within a few decades. Yet the story is not one of helplessness. Some corals have shown an unexpected tolerance for heat, and marine parks that curb overfishing and pollution give reefs the breathing space to recover. Researchers are breeding heat-resistant strains and replanting damaged patches, much as foresters replant a hillside. None of this is a substitute for cutting the emissions that warm the sea in the first place. But it can buy time — and in conservation, time is the one resource that lets everything else recover. A reef, like any city, can be rebuilt if its residents are given room to return.

- A. Alarmed yet hopeful, realistic about limits.
B. Carefree and playful.
C. Cynical, suggesting nothing can be done.
D. Celebratory, as if the crisis is over.

Answer: A — Warning about loss, insistent that effort is worth it.

Trick: Both halves matter — 'most reefs could be lost' and 'the story is not one of helplessness'.

Solution: The passage warns that most reefs 'could be lost within a few decades' yet says 'the story is not one of helplessness' — alarmed but hopeful.

Trap: D ignores the warnings; C ignores the recoveries and replanting.

PASSAGE 10

Q46. What is the central theme of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Every few years a new device is announced as the reform that will finally fix the classroom. The blackboard gave way to the whiteboard; the whiteboard to the projector; the projector to the tablet. Each arrival was greeted with the same promise — that learning would become faster, easier and more equal. The promise has been only partly kept. In some districts, screens have changed little beyond the electricity bill. A well-used screen can bring a village school a laboratory it could never build, a recorded lesson a teacher it could never hire, and a set of tablets a library it could never stock. But the same screen can also become a distraction, a dumping ground for slides, or a substitute for the hard work of explaining an idea clearly. Studies keep finding the same thing: what matters is not the device but the teaching around it. A tablet in an untrained hand changes little; a teacher who knows when to switch it off changes a great deal. The sensible approach, then, is not to chase every new gadget or to ban them all, but to invest first in teachers, then in tools, and to judge both by one question — did the child understand something today that she did not yesterday? Technology, at its best, is a good servant and a poor master.

- A. Technology should be banned from the classroom.
B. Tablets are the single most important education reform.
C. Classroom technology helps only when good teaching surrounds it.
D. Whiteboards were better than projectors.

Answer: C — The device matters less than the teaching around it.

Trick: Find the sentence the passage repeats in different words.

Solution: The passage says 'what matters is not the device but the teaching around it', and closes with 'a good servant and a poor master' — C matches.

Trap: B repeats the promise of the makers that the passage says was 'only partly kept'; D picks a detail the passage treats as a passing sequence.

Q47. Which of the following facts is explicitly stated in the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Every few years a new device is announced as the reform that will finally fix the classroom. The blackboard gave way to the whiteboard; the whiteboard to the projector; the projector to the tablet. Each arrival was greeted with the same promise — that learning would become faster, easier and more equal. The promise has been only partly kept. In some districts, screens have changed little beyond the electricity bill. A well-used screen can bring a village school a laboratory it could never build, a recorded lesson a teacher it could never hire, and a set of tablets a library it could never stock. But the same screen can also become a distraction, a dumping ground for slides, or a substitute for the hard work of explaining an idea clearly. Studies keep finding the same thing: what matters is not the device but the teaching around it. A tablet in an untrained hand changes little; a teacher who knows when to switch it off changes a great deal. The sensible approach, then, is not to chase every new gadget or to ban them all, but to invest first in teachers, then in tools, and to judge both by one question — did the child understand something today that she did not yesterday? Technology, at its best, is a good servant and a poor master.

- A. Devices always make learning faster and more equal.
- B. A recorded lesson can bring a teacher a school could never hire.
- C. Teachers should never switch off a device.
- D. Studies show devices matter more than teaching.

Answer: B — One of the examples of what a screen can do.

Trick: The claim must appear in the example list of the passage, not in the promise of the makers.

Solution: The passage lists what a screen can bring, including 'a recorded lesson a teacher it could never hire' — B is verbatim.

Trap: A repeats the marketing promise the passage judges 'only partly kept'; D inverts the finding of the studies.

Q48. Which of the following best reflects the connection to real-life situations?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Every few years a new device is announced as the reform that will finally fix the classroom. The blackboard gave way to the whiteboard; the whiteboard to the projector; the projector to the tablet. Each arrival was greeted with the same promise — that learning would become faster, easier and more equal. The promise has been only partly kept. In some districts, screens have changed little beyond the electricity bill. A well-used screen can bring a village school a laboratory it could never build, a recorded lesson a teacher it could never hire, and a set of tablets a library it could never stock. But the same screen can also become a distraction, a dumping ground for slides, or a substitute for the hard work of explaining an idea clearly. Studies keep finding the same thing: what matters is not the device but the teaching around it. A tablet in an untrained hand changes little; a teacher who knows when to switch it off changes a great deal. The sensible approach, then, is not to chase every new gadget or to ban them all, but to invest first in teachers, then in tools, and to judge both by one question — did the child understand something today that she did not yesterday? Technology, at its best, is a good servant and a poor master.

- A. A school buys tablets for every child and shelves its teacher-training plan.
- B. A teacher shows slides for the whole period without explanation.
- C. A school bans all devices and returns to rote dictation.
- D. A district trains teachers first, then supplies devices, and reviews whether lessons improved.

Answer: D — Teachers first, tools second, judged by learning.

Trick: Follow the order of investment in the passage: 'first in teachers, then in tools'.

Solution: The passage urges schools 'to invest first in teachers, then in tools', judged by whether the child 'understand something today' — D is that policy.

Trap: A buys the tool without the training, the exact error of 'A tablet in an untrained hand'.

Q49. What is the organisational structure of the passage?

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Every few years a new device is announced as the reform that will finally fix the classroom. The blackboard gave way to the whiteboard; the whiteboard to the projector; the projector to the tablet. Each arrival was greeted with the same promise — that learning would become faster, easier and more equal. The promise has been only partly kept. In some districts, screens have changed little beyond the electricity bill. A well-used screen can bring a village school a laboratory it could never build, a recorded lesson a teacher it could never hire, and a set of tablets a library it could never stock. But the same screen can also become a distraction, a dumping ground for slides, or a substitute for the hard work of explaining an idea clearly. Studies keep finding the same thing: what matters is not the device but the teaching around it. A tablet in an untrained hand changes little; a teacher who knows when to switch it off changes a great deal. The sensible

approach, then, is not to chase every new gadget or to ban them all, but to invest first in teachers, then in tools, and to judge both by one question — did the child understand something today that she did not yesterday? Technology, at its best, is a good servant and a poor master.

A. A pattern of promises is described, its mixed results are weighed, and a measured principle is offered.

B. A pattern of promises is described and the latest device is declared a complete failure.

C. A single classroom is observed for one day and generalised.

D. Two rival companies are compared.

Answer: A — Cycle of promises, mixed record, one principle.

Trick: The tail is a principle, not a verdict on any device.

Solution: The passage traces blackboard to tablet, notes the promise was 'only partly kept', and closes with the principle of the good servant — A fits.

Trap: B stops at failure; the passage credits screens that bring laboratories and lessons, and prescribes judgment, not rejection.

Q50. Identify the tone of the passage.

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Every few years a new device is announced as the reform that will finally fix the classroom. The blackboard gave way to the whiteboard; the whiteboard to the projector; the projector to the tablet. Each arrival was greeted with the same promise — that learning would become faster, easier and more equal. The promise has been only partly kept. In some districts, screens have changed little beyond the electricity bill. A well-used screen can bring a village school a laboratory it could never build, a recorded lesson a teacher it could never hire, and a set of tablets a library it could never stock. But the same screen can also become a distraction, a dumping ground for slides, or a substitute for the hard work of explaining an idea clearly. Studies keep finding the same thing: what matters is not the device but the teaching around it. A tablet in an untrained hand changes little; a teacher who knows when to switch it off changes a great deal. The sensible approach, then, is not to chase every new gadget or to ban them all, but to invest first in teachers, then in tools, and to judge both by one question — did the child understand something today that she did not yesterday? Technology, at its best, is a good servant and a poor master.

A. Enthusiastic, treating every device as a breakthrough.

B. Dismissive, treating technology as worthless.

C. Measured and pragmatic, weighing benefits against risks.

D. Angry at teachers for resisting change.

Answer: C — Neither dazzled nor dismissive; it weighs.

Trick: Check both pans of the balance — the laboratory and the distraction.

Solution: The passage weighs the screen that brings 'a laboratory it could never build' against the one that becomes 'a distraction', concluding with a practical test — C fits.

Trap: A ignores the warnings; B ignores the benefits; D invents a conflict the passage never has.